

ARTIFICIAL NOUVEAU

Selected works. Live performances, installations and video essays that take surveillance drones, deepfakes and predictive policing out of their usual hands and turn them on the audience.

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AI ENGINEER · MEDIA RESEARCHER · COMPUTATIONAL ARTIST

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Ahnjili ZhuParris, PhD (NL/USA), is an AI engineer, media researcher and computational artist. Her work examines AI-enabled surveillance, drone warfare and synthetic media as cultures rather than tools. Working across video essays, installations and live performance, she repurposes these technologies in new contexts to probe the ethical boundaries of their use.

Her doctoral research in medicine used machine learning to predict diagnoses and prognoses from smartphone and wearable data. As an AI engineer she specialises in computer vision and visual retrieval-augmented generation (RAG), and has built computer vision applications for the plastic surgery industry. Her media research applies data science to large-scale audience and media data to examine how narratives take hold across media systems and shape culture.

Ahnjili holds a PhD in Medicine from Leiden University, an MSc in Cognitive Neuroscience from Radboud University and a BSc from the University of Edinburgh. She is a Mozilla Creative Media Award recipient, a Processing Foundation Fellow and a Public AI Creative Fellow. Her work has been supported by the Mozilla Foundation (US), IMPAKT (NL) and Constant (BE), and exhibited at Ars Electronica (AT), Articulating Data (UK), Peckham Digital (UK), GOGBOT Festival (NL), MozFest (ES) and the CICA Museum (KR).

Alongside the practice, Ahnjili gives talks and runs hands-on workshops on AI, surveillance, deepfakes and creative technology for festivals, universities and museums, and takes on bespoke commissions.

EDUCATION

2020–2024	**PhD in Medicine** Leiden University
2016–2018	**MSc Cognitive Neuroscience** Radboud Universiteit
2012–2016	**BSc Biomedical Sciences** University of Edinburgh, with Honours

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

2025	**Public AI Creative Fellowship** MetaGov · USA
2024	**Processing Foundation Fellowship** Processing Foundation · USA
2024	**Digitale Cultuur & Fresh Perspective** Stimuleringsfonds Creatieve Industrie · NL
2024	**Screen-to-Soundscape** SIDN fonds · NL
2021	**Creative Media Award** Mozilla Foundation · USA

SELECTED EXHIBITIONS

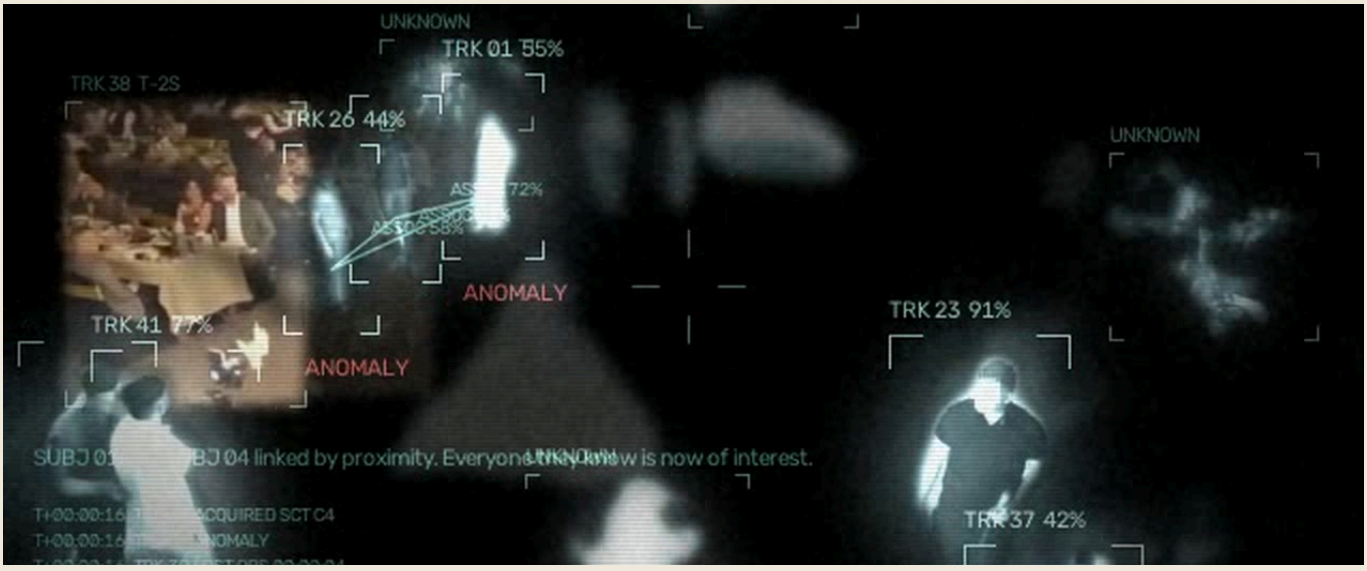
2026	**Close Enough** GOGBOT Festival, Enschede · NL
2026	**Believe the Feed: The Deepfake Archive** MozFest, Barcelona · ES
2024–2026	**Fashion Police Drones** Peckham Digital Festival, UK · New Media Art Conference, CICA Museum, Seoul, KR
2024	**Screen-to-Soundscape / Techno Disobedience** Constant, Brussels · BE
2023	**VOICES** IMPAKT, Utrecht · Ars Electronica, Linz
2023	**Articulating Data** Edinburgh · UK

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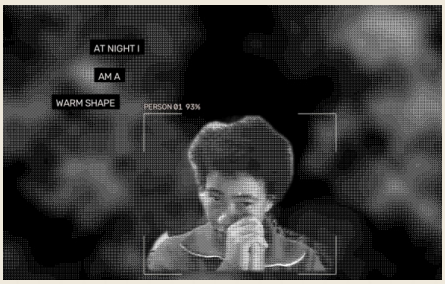
CLOSE ENOUGH

2026

LIVE PERFORMANCE AND INTERACTIVE INSTALLATION · AUTONOMOUS DRONES, FPV, COMPUTER VISION, ANNOTATED LIVE FEED









Close Enough is a live performance and interactive installation about the strange intimacy of drone surveillance. A MALE drone like the Predator circles overhead for weeks while its operator, often on another continent, comes to know a target's routines, relationships and small daily habits before ending their life; operators have described this in testimony as a form of stalking. With an FPV drone the pilot is still distant, but the drone itself is often the weapon, meeting a person face to face in their final moments. Each drone creates its own kind of closeness, and the work moves between them.

The work unfolds in three acts. A pilot sleeps beneath their own drones and dreams in the language of the machine while the audience watches the sleeper through its eyes. A video essay scrolls through the feed of a drone-war veteran, tracing how the screens that carry friendship and love came to carry war. Then the pilot's shift begins: wearing FPV goggles, they hunt the audience with live drones, and each visitor is noticed, followed, recorded and filed. After the show the recordings are cut into clips and posted to social media, and the audience joins the feed they have just been watching.

MEDIUM

Live performance and interactive installation in three acts. Autonomous and FPV drones, computer vision, annotated live feed, video essay.

PREMIERED

GOGBOT Festival, Enschede, Netherlands, September 2026

COLLABORATORS

Flora Reznik (film editor) · Luz Lassizuk (dramaturg)

WATCH

vimeo.com/1225022507

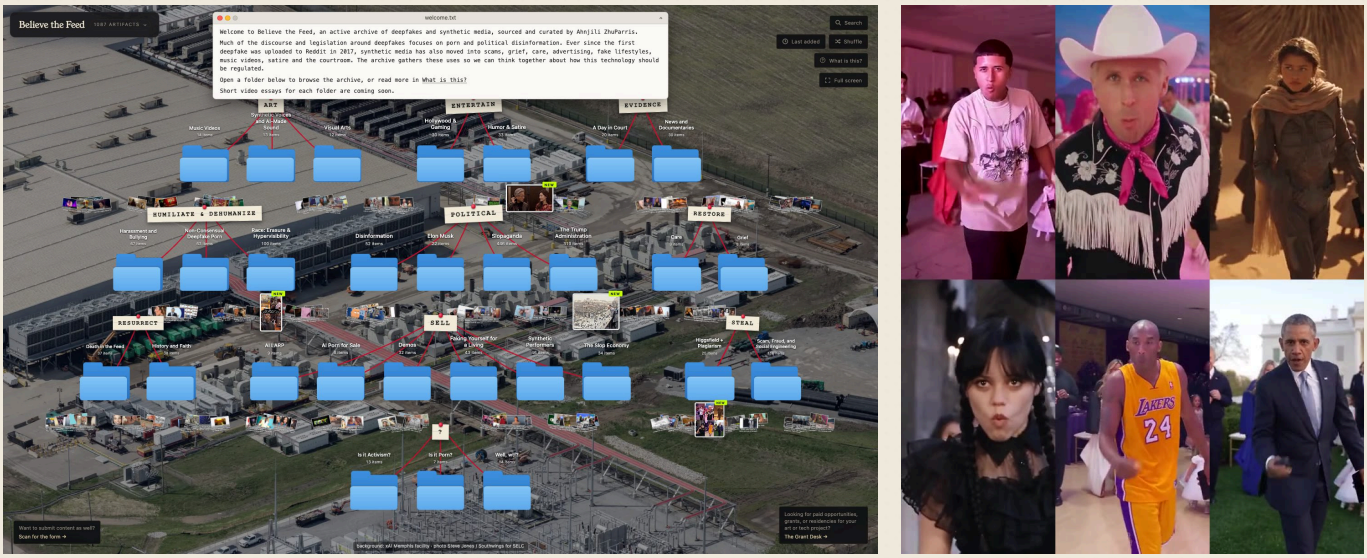
ONLINE

artificialnouveau.com/gallery/close-enough

BELIEVE THE FEED

2026

THE DEEPFAKE ARCHIVE · ONLINE ARCHIVE, INTERACTIVE NETWORK GRAPH, CURATORIAL PANELS



LEFT: THE ARCHIVE'S FOLDER LAYOUT. RIGHT: A PARTY DANCE COPIED ONTO KEN, CHANI, WEDNESDAY, KOBE BRYANT AND OBAMA WITH HIGGSFIELD GENJUTSU.

Believe the Feed is an active archive of deepfakes and synthetic media. Much of the discourse and legislation around deepfakes focuses on porn and political disinformation, but since the first deepfake was uploaded to Reddit in 2017, synthetic media has also moved into scams, grief, care, advertising, fake lifestyles, music videos, satire and the courtroom. Since making *DEEPFAKE: A Video Essay*, I have been cataloguing these unusual and emerging uses, organised by intent at creation rather than technique, so that researchers and legislators can think together about how the technology should be regulated.

Each artifact carries a curatorial panel that names the toolchain, the consent status and the concrete consequence to the people involved, in a register that is allergic to both AI-hype credulity and moral-panic credulity. Where the artifact itself is abuse, the panels link to journalism and court documents instead of exhibiting the media.

MEDIUM

Online archive. Interactive network graph, curatorial panels, structured metadata.

STRUCTURE

Folders by intent at creation, one artifact per node, edges by shared intent and toolchain.

PREMIERED

MozFest 2026, Barcelona, Spain

STATUS

Live build: over 1,100 artifacts. Corpus still growing.

ONLINE

artificialnouveau.com/deepfakearchive

DEEPFAKE: A VIDEO ESSAY

2025

VIDEO ESSAY · LIVE INSTALLATION WITH REAL-TIME FACE REPLACEMENT



DEEPFAKE is both a video essay and a live installation, two forms that examine the cultural and emotional impact of synthetic media. From AI-powered memorials to non-consensual pornography, the essay looks at what happens when a likeness can be taken and a record rewritten without anyone's consent. Our bodies are no longer private, they are programmable.

The installation runs real-time deepfake technology in the room, so visitors watch their own faces being replaced and manipulated in front of them. Its goal is to put the audience on edge: once a likeness can be captured this easily, no one in the room knows when theirs might be used to violate their consent. What the essay argues on screen becomes something the audience feels about their own image.

MEDIUM

Video essay and live installation with real-time deepfake technology.

VIDEOGRAPHY

Flora Reznik

PRESENTED

Peckham Digital, London, United Kingdom, 2025

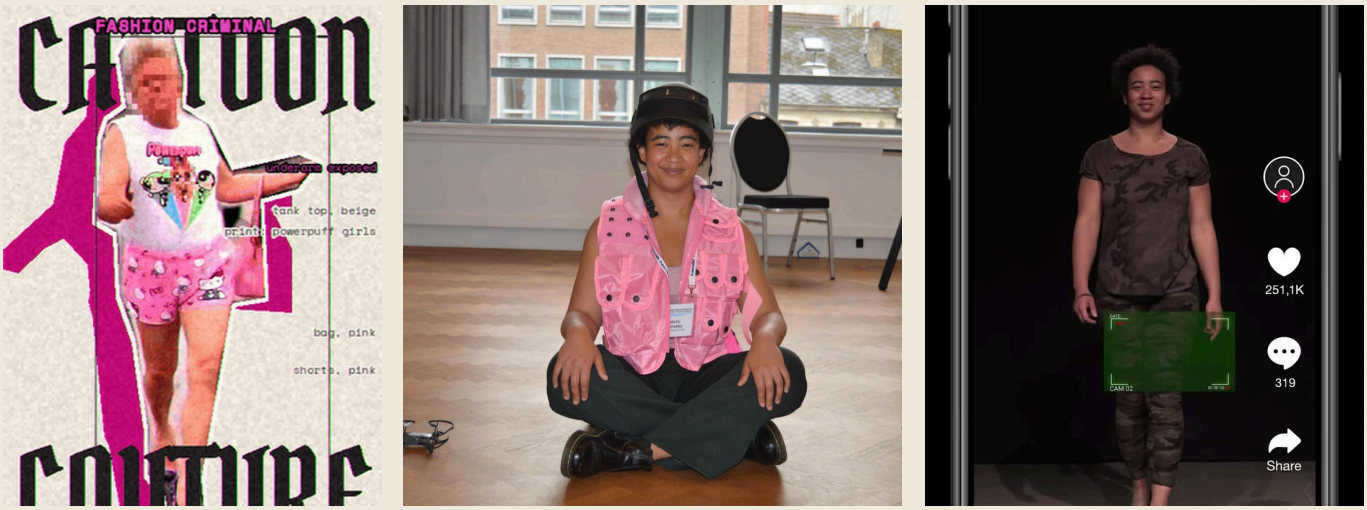
WATCH

vimeo.com/1082448682

FASHION POLICE DRONES

2024

INTERACTIVE INSTALLATION · DRONES, COMPUTER VISION, REAL-TIME USER INTERACTION



TOP: A VERDICT PANEL FROM THE DRONE FEED AND THE DRONES PATROLLING FOR CORPORATE FASHION CRIMES. BOTTOM: INSTALLATION AT PECKHAM DIGITAL, LONDON, 2026.

Fashion Police Drones turns commercial drones into a fashion police force. The drones patrol the room while computer vision reads what each visitor is wearing, and an announcer voice reads the verdicts out loud as a transcript types along. Every stop escalates through three stages, and the law gets harsher at each one.

In the first stage, Cute Patrol, visitors are judged on what they are wearing, and on whether the pilot thinks the outfit is cute or not; either answer sends the stop further. In the second, Stop and Search, they are judged on who the machine takes them to be: a protester, a student, a tourist. In the third, Morality Police, they are judged under real dress-code laws from around the world, from Iran's hijab law to France's face-veil ban, and sentenced.

The point is how little it takes. One person with a few commercial drones can build the apparatus of a fascist state and inflict it on a room of strangers, watching, sorting and punishing people for how they look and who they appear to be.

MEDIUM

Interactive installation. Drones, computer vision, real-time user interaction and interface design.

PRESENTED

Peckham Digital Festival, United Kingdom, 2026
New Media Art Conference, CICA Museum, Seoul, Republic of Korea, 2024
CPDP Conference, invited by Privacy Salon, Brussels, Belgium, 2024

ONLINE

artificialnouveau.com/gallery/fashion_police_drones

BOOKING

Available to travel.
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BABBLE ON

2023

INTERACTIVE WEB INSTALLATION · BROWSER-BASED AUDIO, VOICE MASKING



PARTICIPANTS RECORD A FEW SENTENCES; THE BROWSER RETURNS A BABBLE TAPE IN THEIR OWN VOICE.

BabbleOn is an interactive web installation for making babble tapes, audio that hides a conversation by burying it in indistinct speech with the same acoustic qualities. A recording device captures a room that sounds full of talk but yields no usable speech. Participants record a few sentences and the tape is built from their own voice.

Against increasingly capable multi-speaker identification systems, the work offers a personal countermeasure. Participants record one or two sentences, which are chopped, layered and remixed into a customised babble tape infused with the distinct properties of their own voice, like a restaurant where everyone sounds like you. The tape can be downloaded and kept. All processing happens in the browser; nothing is uploaded or stored.

MEDIUM

Interactive web installation. Browser-based audio capture and processing.

METHOD

Record, chop, layer at random offsets, speeds and volumes, download.

PRIVACY

Processed entirely in the browser. No upload, no storage.

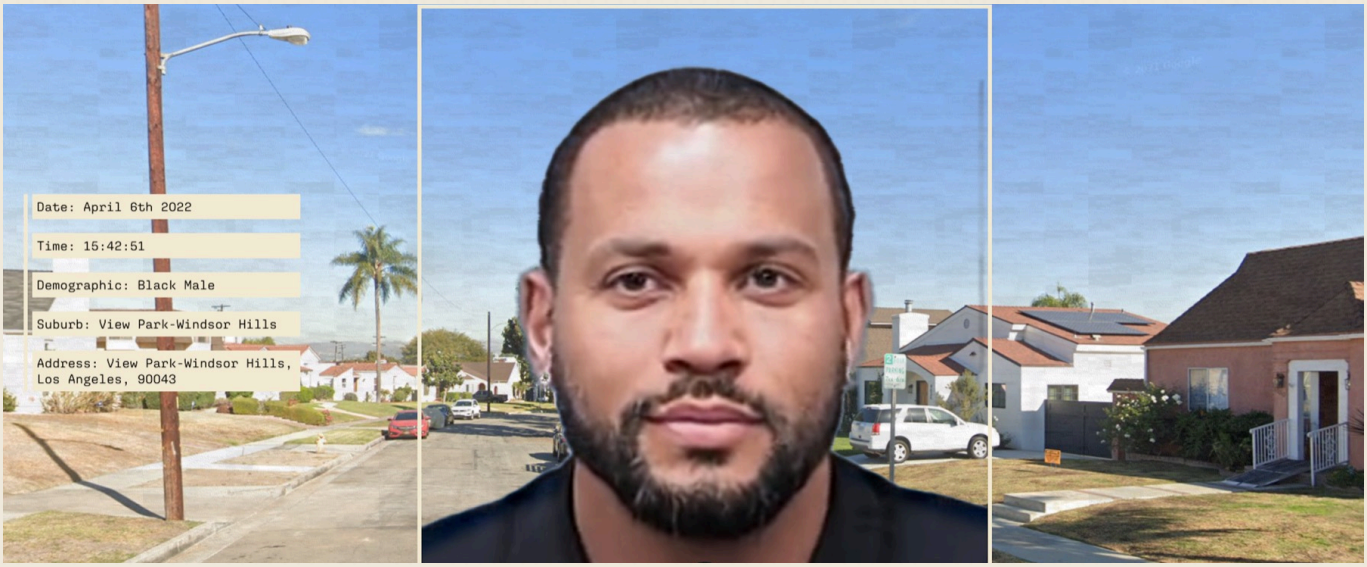
ONLINE

artificialnouveau.com/gallery/babble

FUTURE WAKE

2021

INTERACTIVE WEBSITE · AI, DEEPFAKES, SYNTHETIC MEDIA, STATISTICS · GENERATED AVATARS, SYNTHETIC VOICE





COMPOSITE VICTIMS, GENERATED FROM US FATAL-POLICE-ENCOUNTER DATA, EACH NARRATING THEIR ENCOUNTER WITH THE POLICE.

Future Wake is an interactive website about predictive policing, focused on forecasting police brutality. It uses data on fatal police encounters in the United States to predict future incidents, and returns each one as a computer-simulated avatar of a composite victim who narrates their own story. It won the Mozilla 2021 Creative Media Award.

Predicting victims instead of offenders, and doing it through faces and voices rather than statistics, puts the question back the other way: what these systems call safety, and who they leave out.

MEDIUM

Interactive website. AI, deepfakes, synthetic media, statistics. Machine learning, generated avatars, synthetic voice.

WITH

Tim van Ommeren

AWARD

Mozilla Creative Media Award, Mozilla Foundation, 2021

PRESS

It's Nice That · Coda Story · Embodying Data, Shifting Perspective (book chapter)

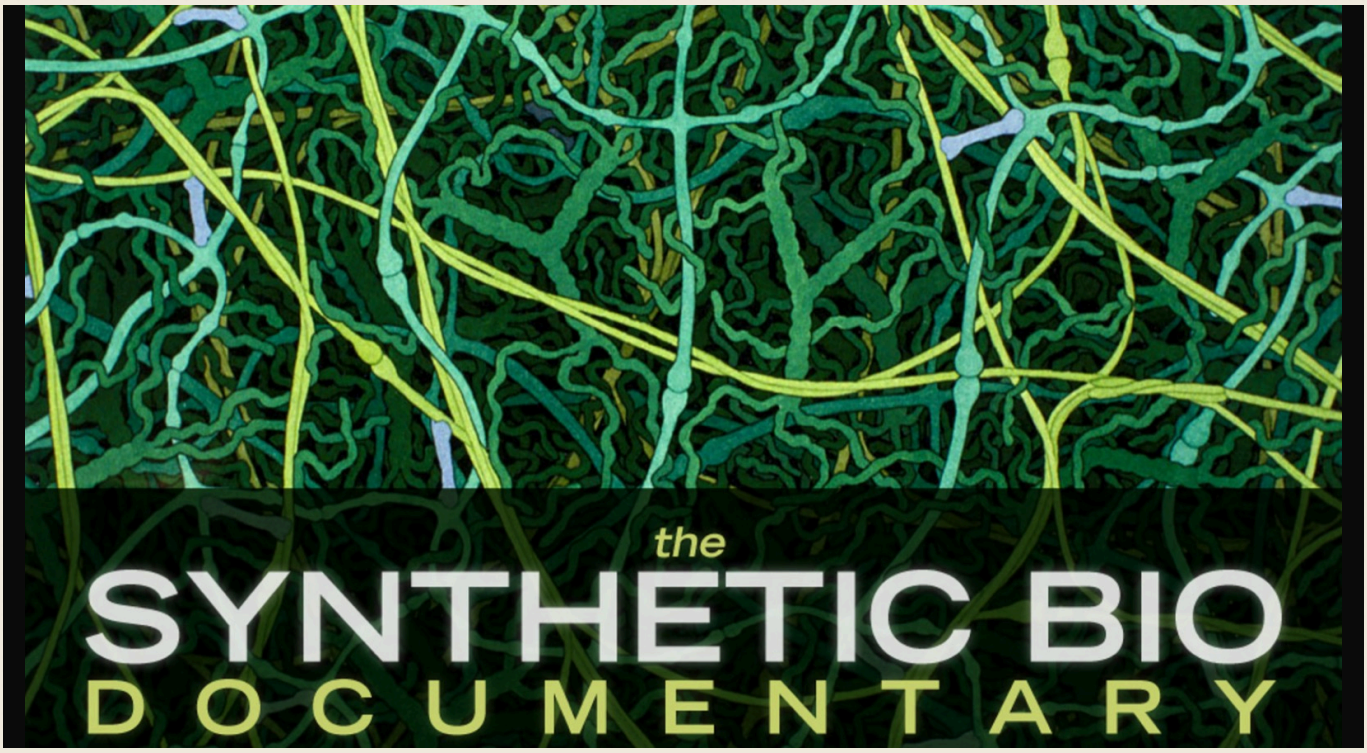
SITE

futurewake.com

SYNTHETIC BIOLOGY: A NEW CODE FOR LIFE

2014

DOCUMENTARY · TEN YEARS OF SYNTHETIC BIOLOGY, FROM ENGINEERED BACTERIA TO SPIDER SILK



TRAILER AT VIMEO.COM/22153761

This documentary explores the emerging field of synthetic biology, where DNA is treated as programmable code and cells as genetic circuits. It covers ten years of advances, from engineering E. coli to smell like fresh rain to goats producing spider silk in their milk, and asks what happens to a discipline once its material becomes something to be written rather than only read.

The film sets those advances against the ethical questions they raise: how life is defined, where the boundaries of genetic engineering should sit, and who gets to draw them. It is the earliest work in this portfolio and the first statement of a question the later works keep asking in other materials, about bodies rendered as data and rewritten by the systems that read them.

MEDIUM

Documentary film

SUBJECT

Synthetic biology's first decade: engineered E. coli, spider silk in goat milk, genetic circuits.

TRAILER

vimeo.com/22153761